

GUIDE

Agentic Transformation for Energy Developers

From early stage development to financial close: process first, data second, agents third.

November 2026 | 20 minute read | Onshore wind, solar, storage and offshore wind

Yorik Tisseau Founder, Ignis Leadership

ignisleadership.com

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00 THE ANSWER FIRST

Agents speed up whatever process they sit on. Fix the process, then add them.

For CEOs, commercial, development and portfolio leaders at energy developers, and their boards. Gartner expects over 40% of agentic AI projects to be cancelled by the end of 2027, citing escalating costs, unclear business value or inadequate risk controls.[1] In the Ignis view, the usual cause is the order: tool first, process last.

EACH MONTH A PROJECT WAITS

about £0.22m

lost in today's money, 60 MW solar example

SENIOR TIME ON REWORK

your number

No public dataset exists. Measure it in week 1.

Example project: 60 MW solar, 11% capacity factor (assumption)	**57,816 MWh a year**
Revenue at the AR7 solar price: 57,816 × £65.23[6]	**about £3.77m a year**
Value of 20 years of revenue today, at 7% (assumption): £3.77m × 10.594	**about £39.9m**
One month later: £39.9m × (1 − $1/1.07^{1/12}$)	**about £0.22m lost**

Worked example, not a client. 60 MW, 11% capacity factor, 7% discount rate and one month of delay are Ignis assumptions. AR7 solar price £65.23/MWh in 2024 prices. Method on page 23.

THREE FINDINGS

1. **The queue has outgrown the way most teams work.** About 1,700 GW of renewable and hybrid projects wait for grid connections across 16 European countries.[2] Evidence, grid and auction work now move together. The time goes in the handovers.
2. **Agentic means goal-driven, with people at the gates.** An agent plans the steps, works from your documents, checks its output and stops where a named person decides.
3. **Most of the value is in the order.** Process first, data second, agents third. Two weeks of discovery tells you where agents would and would not help.

DECIDE BY 15 DECEMBER 2026

Which workflow to map first. A 90-day pilot started in early January ends by mid-March 2027, as AR8 contracts are signed (indicatively 4 to 17 March) and the 18-month milestone clock starts.[7,8]

Sources on this page. 1 Gartner, 25 Jun 2025. 2 Beyond Fossil Fuels, E3G, Ember and IEEFA, 13 May 2025. 6 DESNZ, 10 Feb 2026. 7 Rendaq, 15 Oct 2026. 8 DESNZ, AR8 CfD Agreement, May 2026. Full references on page 23.

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00 AT A GLANCE

Commercial pressure is the entry point. A better way of working is the prize.

FIVE MESSAGES FOR YOUR LEADERSHIP TEAM

1 **Transformation is not adding agents.** It starts with the work: the process, the bottleneck, the evidence and the real problem behind them. Automate a broken process and you get a faster broken process.

2 **Every commitment rests on evidence.** Land, consent, grid, price and contracts change all the time. The aim is to turn that changing evidence into controlled decisions.

3 **The lifecycle is one chain of decisions,** from site to financial close. Much of the delay sits in the handovers, which is where a shared project record helps most.

4 **Introduce in steps:** task agents first, then connectors to the tools you already use, then an AI manager across stages. In our view most energy developers sit on step 1 or 2 of five.

5 **Start small, start fast.** Find the two or three biggest pain points, redesign the process, then pilot and embed with your own team within 90 days.

Who this guide is for

CEOs, commercial, development and portfolio leaders at energy developers across the UK and Europe: onshore wind, solar, battery storage and offshore wind. Also boards and investors asking "what is our AI plan?" It is platform-agnostic: no particular software is assumed.

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Tools you can use

- Five questions before any automation
- A five-step maturity ladder and ten-question self-check
- Three worked commercial workflows in one common format
- A 90-day path from first map to embedded pilot

00 INTRODUCTION

Transformation is not adding agents

So what: start with the work, not the tool. Ask why it takes as long as it does, and whether it is the right work.

A grid connection evidence pack, a tender comparison, a lender's due diligence log. In many development teams each of these is rebuilt by hand, from several inboxes and three versions of the same spreadsheet. Put an agent on top of that and it will rebuild the pack faster, still from the wrong version, with the same handovers and the same waiting.

Commercial pressure is the entry point: a bid deadline, a tender, a slipped connection date. Transformation follows when the organisation redesigns the process, the data and the human and agent workflow behind that immediate work.

This is not a new idea. Operations leaders have long made the same point: get the operation right before you automate it. What has changed is the size of the prize. Agents can now read, compare, draft and check across a whole project, which makes a well-designed process far more valuable, and a badly designed one far more expensive.

That is the order this guide follows, and the order we recommend.

THE IGNIS PRINCIPLE

Redesign the decision and the evidence behind it first. Then let agents carry the groundwork, with named people deciding at the gates.

THE ORDER THAT WORKS

1 **Process first**

What do you run today? Map the workflow as it really happens. Find where work waits. Question each requirement, remove what does not earn its place, simplify what is left.

2 **Data second**

What does the work run on? One record per project. Documents, decisions and assumptions structured, versioned and owned, so people and agents read the same truth.

3 **Agents third**

Then add the agents. Let them carry the tracking, comparing and drafting on the redesigned process, with named people deciding at the gates.

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00 WHY NOW

The queue has outgrown the way most teams work

So what: pipelines are bigger and gates tighter, but teams are the same size. The old way of working no longer scales.

1,700 GW

Renewable and hybrid projects waiting for a grid connection across 16 European countries: over three times the capacity additions needed for the EU's 2030 targets.[2]

444 GW

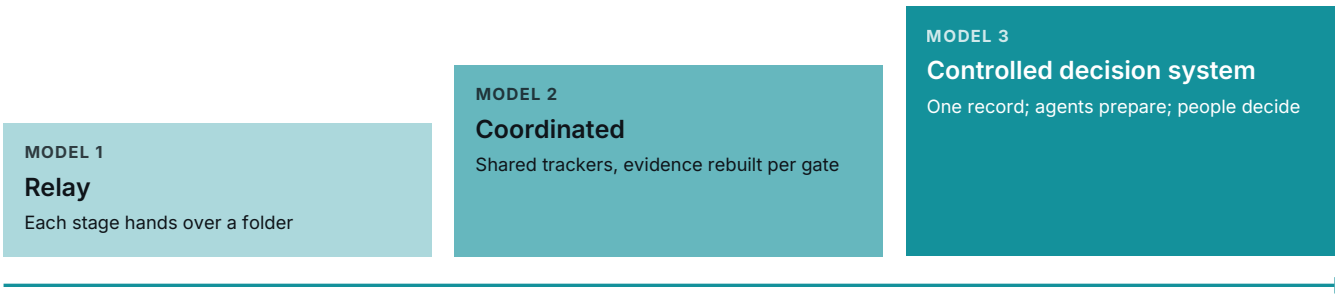
New GB connection applications, transmission and distribution, in 2023/24, against 233 GW in 2019/20.[3]

1 to 3 years

Maximum permit-granting times the EU now sets for renewables, inside and outside acceleration areas, onshore and offshore.[5]

This is not a British or an offshore story. For onshore wind, solar, storage and offshore wind alike, grid, permits and auction evidence now move together, and the work between them is where time goes. In Britain, connections reform has prioritised 283 GW of generation and storage, and more than 300 GW in the old queue will not move forward.[4] Every one of those outcomes changed the evidence behind someone's commercial decisions.

THREE OPERATING MODELS FOR DEVELOPMENT WORK



More control over evidence and decisions, with the same team

Relay. Each stage runs its own work and hands over a folder. Knowledge lives in people's heads and inboxes. Decisions are made in sequence, one team at a time.

Coordinated. Shared trackers and templates. Stages talk earlier, but evidence is still rebuilt for each gate and the reasons behind decisions are hard to trace.

Controlled decision system. One record holds the evidence, assumptions and decisions. Agents carry the groundwork, named people decide at the gates, and each project teaches the next.

The difference is control, not technology. No team can hand groundwork to agents without a map of its process and its evidence. That is why the work starts there, and why most of it is commercial, not technical.

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A NOTE FROM YORIK

Agents come to help people, not to take their jobs. The prize is not only doing today's work for less. It is giving your best people back their time for negotiation, community work and judgement, and launching offers you could not run before.

Sources on this page. 2 Beyond Fossil Fuels, E3G, Ember and IEEFA, 13 May 2025. 3 Ofgem, connections reform decision, 15 Apr 2025. 4 NESO, 8 Dec 2025. 5 Directive (EU) 2023/2413, Articles 16a and 16b.

What agentic means, in plain words

So what: a chatbot answers and automation repeats. An agent pursues a goal, then stops where a person must decide.

	Chatbot or assistant	Automation	Agent	Agentic system
What it does	You ask, it answers	Follows fixed rules you wrote	Pursues a goal across several steps, using tools and documents	Several agents working together on one shared project record
Handles change	Only if you re-explain it	Breaks when rules or formats change	Adapts its plan to new formats and gaps	Adapts, and carries lessons across stages and projects
Who decides	You, each time	The rule	A named person, at a gate	Named people at defined gates, with an audit trail
In development	Summarise one consultation response	Fill a fixed tender template	Compare three EPC returns like for like and flag the gaps	The grid view informs the bid; the bid informs the tender

What stays human

Relationships with landowners, communities, grid operators and lenders. Judgement under uncertainty. The name on the commitment. People keep the decisions; agents carry the tables, the trackers and the first drafts.

Beware "agent washing"

Gartner warns that many vendors are rebranding assistants, robotic process automation and chatbots as agents, and estimates that only about 130 of the thousands of agentic AI vendors are real.[1] A plain test: does it pursue a goal across steps, work from your documents, and stop at your gates?

WORKED EXAMPLE, NOT A CLIENT

One task, three ways: comparing three EPC returns

Chatbot: someone pastes sections in one at a time. No memory of the tender, no view of what is missing.

Automation: a fixed spreadsheet template works until a bidder uses a new format, then breaks.

Agent: reads all three returns, normalises scope and price, flags exclusions and missing items, cites the page for each point, and hands a draft comparison to the commercial lead to decide.

> People keep the decisions. Agents carry the tables.

Source on this page. 1 Gartner, 25 Jun 2025.



PART 2 | THE METHOD

From one chain of decisions to a governed system

How the development lifecycle really runs, where value leaks between stages, and how to introduce agents one controlled step at a time.

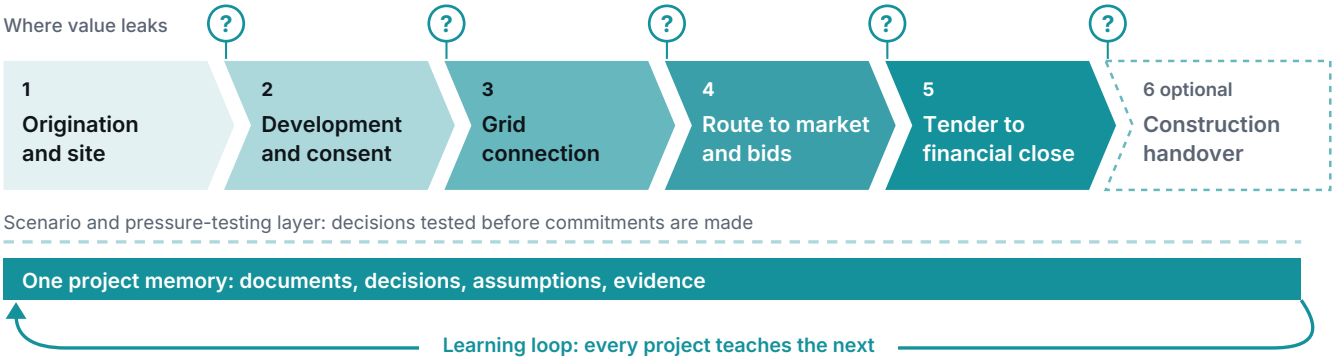
Across the lifecycle	8	Governance: who is accountable	12
Start with what you run today	10	The maturity ladder and self-check	14
Inside an agentic system	11	Barriers and use cases	16

Photo: offshore wind turbines. Andy Dingley, edited by Muhammad, CC BY-SA 3.0, via Wikimedia Commons, cropped.

02 ACROSS THE LIFECYCLE

From site to financial close, one chain of decisions

So what: each stage makes decisions the next one depends on. Value is lost in the handovers, where a shared project record helps most.



The stages are the same whether you develop onshore wind in Scotland, solar in Spain, storage in Germany or offshore wind off France or Ireland. The instruments differ: auctions, tenders, seabed rounds, grid rules and permits vary by country. The pattern does not. Each handover risks passing on a folder rather than the reasons behind it.

Stage	Key decisions	Where value leaks	Where agents help
1 **Origination and site**	Which sites to pursue, which to drop, and why	Screening judgements live in one person's head; constraints are re-checked from scratch for the next site	Screen constraints, grid headroom and planning history; draft a ranked long list with the evidence for each site
2 **Development and consent**	Design freeze, consent strategy, responses to consultees	Responses and conditions sit in spreadsheets; design changes are not reflected in every chapter	Triage consultation responses, track conditions, cross-check chapters against the latest design
3 **Grid connection**	Accept, modify, share or drop a connection	Evidence is rebuilt for every gate; milestones and securities are tracked by hand	Assemble evidence packs, check offers against the application, track milestones and securities
4 **Route to market and bids**	Where to bid, at what price, on what evidence	Evidence and lessons are rebuilt for each round; compliance is checked late	Keep an evidence library, draft first sections, check compliance against round rules
5 **Tender to financial close**	Preferred bidders, risk allocation, the final sign-off	Offers are not like for like; clarifications are lost in email; due diligence questions are answered twice	Normalise offers, control clarifications, track due diligence questions and conditions precedent
6 Construction handover	Who owns each residual risk	Award day becomes a reset; delivery re-learns what development knew	Compile the handover pack with the decision record and risk owners

Where value leaks: the handovers

So what: ask five questions at the next handover. Any answer of "only if the right person remembers" marks a workflow to redesign.

14.7 GW

Awarded in Great Britain's seventh CfD round: 8.4 GW offshore wind, 4.9 GW solar and 1.3 GW onshore wind.[6]

18 months

From an AR8 CfD's Agreement Date to its Initial Milestone Delivery Date.[8]

> A handover should pass on a record of decisions, not a folder.

One lifecycle, many markets

Great Britain: Contracts for Difference auctions, connections reform with Gate 2, and seabed leasing rounds. For AR8, the government set a Gate 2 connection position as the general entry requirement.[9]

Across the EU: national auctions and tenders, grid queues, and maximum permitting times under RED III.[5]

The names change; the chain of decisions does not.

FIVE HANDOVER QUESTIONS TO ASK ON YOUR NEXT PROJECT

SITE TO DEVELOPMENT
Do the reasons behind the screening decision travel with the site?

DEVELOPMENT TO GRID
Does the grid application reflect the latest design and consent position?

GRID TO BIDS
Are the connection date and evidence in the bid the same as in the offer?

BIDS TO TENDER
Do the tender specifications carry the commitments made in the bid?

TENDER TO DELIVERY
Does delivery receive the decision record and the owner of each residual risk?

Sources on this page. 5 Directive (EU) 2023/2413. 6 DESNZ, 10 Feb 2026. 8 DESNZ, AR8 CfD Agreement, May 2026. 9 DESNZ, AR8 government response, Jul 2026.

Start with what you run today

So what: find the bottleneck before designing any agent. Often the first fix is a decision, not a technology.

Five questions before any automation

1. **What do you run today?** List the recurring workflows by stage: bid packs, grid evidence, tender evaluations, due diligence questions, board papers. Note who runs each one and how often.
2. **What is the process, really?** Map one workflow end to end as it actually happens, not as the procedure says: steps, decisions, owners, handovers, documents and versions.
3. **Where is the bottleneck?** Find where work waits: for a person, a document, a sign-off, a version, a reply from a counterparty.
4. **What is the real problem?** Question each requirement and name who set it. Is the problem the drafting, or that the evidence is rebuilt from scratch every time?
5. **What can you remove, simplify or structure first?** Delete steps that do not earn their place, merge reviews, agree one record per project. Then automate what remains.

WORKED EXAMPLE, NOT A CLIENT

A tender evaluation, fixed before it is automated

Today: three EPC returns arrive in three formats. An analyst rebuilds a comparison spreadsheet by hand. Clarifications run through email.

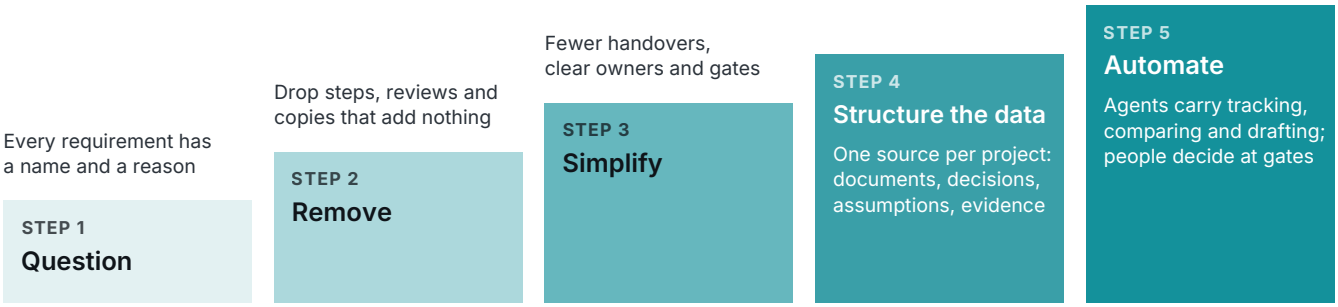
Asking why: the tender never asked for a standard return format, and there is no single clarification log.

Fix first: issue a structured return template and one clarification log. Agree who decides what.

Then the agent: normalises the returns, flags gaps and exclusions, cites the page for each point and keeps the log current. The commercial lead decides.

> Often the first fix costs nothing but a decision.

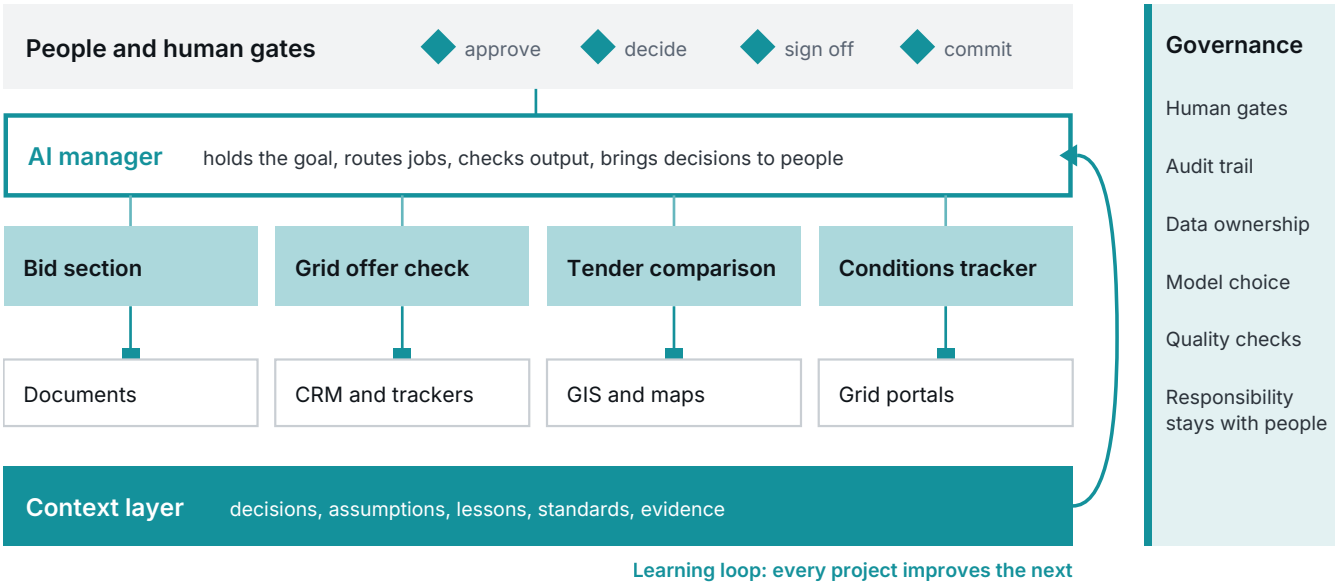
FROM BOTTLENECK TO AGENT: THE SEQUENCE WE USE



Question, remove, simplify, structure, automate last. Ignis view, not data.

Inside an agentic system

So what: an agentic system is a team, not a tool. An AI manager coordinates specialist agents on a record you own, under governance your people control.



Light teal: task agents. Outlined: connectors into the tools you already use.

The AI manager

Holds the goal, for example "a compliant, evidence-backed grid pack by the deadline". It breaks the goal into jobs, routes each to the right agent, checks the output and brings decisions to people at the gates. It never makes the commitment itself.

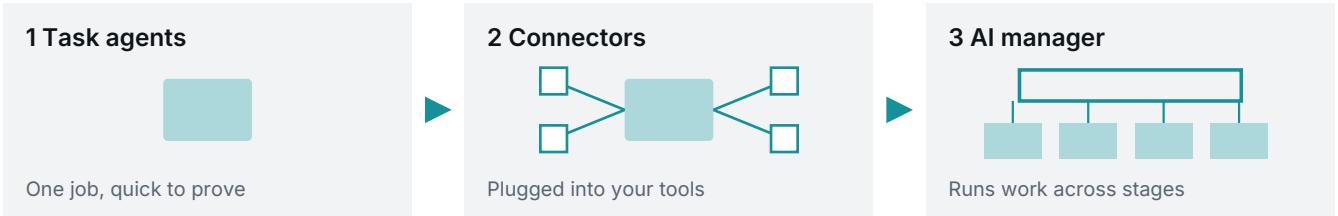
Agents and connectors

Task agents do single, well-defined jobs: drafting a bid section, checking a grid offer against the application, normalising tender returns. Connectors link them into your document stores, CRM, GIS, portals and trackers.

The context layer

The shared record every agent works from: decisions and the reasons for them, assumptions, lessons, standards and evidence. It is owned by you, kept in your environment, and improves with every project.

THE STEP-BY-STEP PATH



Start where it hurts. Redesign the workflow behind the biggest pain point, prove one or two task agents on it, then connect them to your tools. The AI manager comes in once several workflows share one record. On the ladder (page 14), this is steps 3 to 5.

Governance: accountability does not move

So what: agents take on groundwork, never accountability. Your board will ask six questions. Each has a control and a named owner.

THE BOARD ASKS	THE CONTROL	WHO OWNS IT
Who approves what an agent produces?	Human gates at defined points. Nothing leaves the company without a named person's sign-off.	The gate owner, named for each workflow
Can we show how a figure was reached?	An audit trail. Every output links to its sources and records who approved it, and when.	The workflow owner
Who owns the data and the record?	Your data and context layer stay in your environment, with role-based access.	You; your IT team sets access
Are we locked in to one model or vendor?	Design the workflow first and stay tool-agnostic, so models and vendors can be swapped as the market moves.	Your IT lead
How do we catch errors before a counterparty does?	Evidence-linked outputs, checks against round rules and house standards, and a challenge review at the gate.	The reviewer named for each gate
Who answers for the decision?	People. An agent cannot answer for a decision; the person who approves it can.	The accountable executive

Over 40%

of agentic AI projects will be cancelled by the end of 2027, Gartner predicts, because of escalating costs, unclear business value or inadequate risk controls.[1]

> Unclear value and weak risk controls are leadership questions, not technical ones. Answer them before the pilot, not after.

Source on this page. 1 Gartner, 25 Jun 2025.

Cost: size the pilot honestly

So what: the largest cost is often your own people's time. Measure today's effort first, so the pilot has something to be judged against.

What drives the cost

Category	What it covers
Buy or commission	Platform licences, a commissioned system, or a mix of both
Model usage	Pay per use; grows with document volume and how often agents run
Integration	Connectors, data clean-up and security review
People's time	Mapping the workflow, sitting at the gates, reviewing and training. Easy to overlook
Ongoing running	Monitoring, model updates, keeping the context layer current, support

Sizing a pilot

- One project, one workflow, one document set (roughly 50 to 200 files).
- Measure today's effort on that workflow before you start.
- Estimate runs per month and time at the gates.
- Agree in advance what "worth continuing" looks like.

Measures to establish before the pilot starts

These are baselines to record, not results we claim. Pick three that matter for the chosen workflow.

◆ Waiting time

Days between a request and a gate-ready pack.

◆ Rebuilds

How often the same evidence is assembled again from scratch.

◆ Open questions

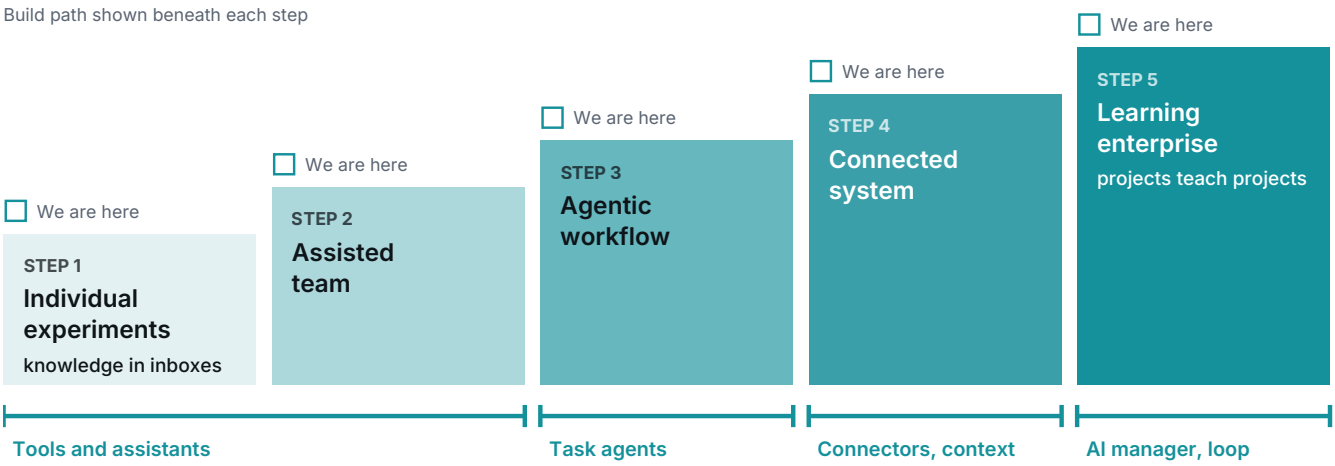
Clarifications or due diligence questions without an owner or a due date.

◆ Version conflicts

Differences between the model, the contract draft and the board paper.

Where are you today?

So what: in our view most energy developers sit on step 1 or 2. The value jump is step 3: one workflow end to end, with human gates. Climb one step at a time.



Step	What it looks like	Signals you are here	Move up by
1 Individual experiments	People use public chat tools on their own; no shared rules	Personal chat accounts; data pasted ad hoc	A simple AI use policy and one sanctioned tool
2 Assisted team	Shared, governed tools on project documents	Faster drafting; still one person, one task	Mapping one painful workflow end to end
3 Agentic workflow	Agents run one redesigned workflow with named gates and an audit trail	Hours move from production to judgement	Connecting it to a shared project record
4 Connected system	Several workflows share one record; scenarios tested before decisions	Handovers carry decisions and evidence	Adding a learning loop, and measuring it
5 Learning enterprise	Each project improves the next; new offers built on the system	New services; more repeatable projects	Keep improving; open selected interfaces to partners

Ignis framework, not data. Step 5 is a direction of travel.

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04 SELF-CHECK

Ten questions to place your team

So what: answer honestly, one tick for each yes. The score tells you which step to work on next, not how you compare with anyone else.

1	We have an AI use policy that people actually follow	☐
2	People use a sanctioned tool, not personal accounts	☐
3	Teams share governed tools and templates on project documents	☐
4	We have mapped at least one painful workflow end to end	☐
5	One workflow runs with agents, named gates and an audit trail	☐
6	We measured that workflow's effort before and after	☐
7	A new joiner can find why we chose our EPC contractor in under ten minutes	☐
8	Handovers between stages carry decisions and evidence	☐
9	Lessons from each project feed the next bid, tender or site screen	☐
10	We have tested an offer the system makes possible	☐

What your score means

0 TO 2
Start with a policy and one mapped workflow.

3 TO 5
You are ready for a first agentic workflow.

6 TO 8
Connect workflows to a shared project record.

9 TO 10
Set up the learning loop and test new offers.

Ignis view: a conversation starter, not a benchmark.

05 BARRIERS TO IMPLEMENTATION

The blocker is rarely the technology

So what: process, data, governance, trust, skills and procurement get in the way first. Each has a first move you can make this quarter.

Barrier	The symptom	The first move
Data and documents	The latest version is somewhere in an inbox	One project's document set (roughly 50 to 200 files), not a data lake
Governance and accountability	No one is sure who signs off agent output	Named human gates and an audit trail for each workflow
Trust and accuracy	Fear of one wrong figure in a bid or board paper	Evidence-linked outputs, where every claim points to a page, and a challenge review at the gate
Skills and roles	Teams are unsure how to work alongside agents	Agents take the tracker and the comparison; people keep negotiation, community work and design
Procurement and IT	Buying a platform before redesigning the work	Redesign the workflow first and stay tool-agnostic. Gartner calls rethinking workflows from the ground up the ideal path in many cases[1]
Confidentiality and IP	Bid strategy, pricing and lender terms are sensitive	Keep the record and the IP in your own environment, under your own access rules
Board and investor expectations	Pressure for an AI plan without a value case	One efficiency case and one new-offer case, each tied to a named pain point
Change fatigue and time	The team is already at capacity	A 90-day path built around one live project, not a programme

Process first. Data second. Agents third.

Source on this page. 1 Gartner, 25 Jun 2025.

Pick two: one that gives time back, one that opens a new offer

So what: every stage has a case of each kind. These are possibilities to test, not claimed results.

Stage	TIME BACK What the agent carries	NEW OFFER What becomes possible	What people keep
Origination and site	Screens constraints, grid headroom and planning history; drafts a ranked long list	Screen more sites, and partner on or sell screened sites to other developers or funds	Landowner relationships; which sites to back
Development and consent	Triages consultation responses; tracks conditions; cross-checks chapters against the latest design	Community benefit offers shaped by what consultees actually raised across projects	Community dialogue; design choices
Grid connection	Assembles readiness evidence; reviews offers; tracks milestones and securities	Treat the connection as an asset: model sharing, hybridising or co-locating	Negotiation with the network operator
Route to market and bids	Keeps an evidence library; drafts first sections; checks compliance with round rules	Enter more rounds and markets with the same team	Bid strategy and price
Tender to financial close	Normalises offers; controls clarifications; tracks due diligence and conditions precedent	Cleaner data rooms for refinancing or stake sales; development services for co-investors	Risk allocation; the signature
Construction handover	Compiles the handover pack with the decision record and residual risk owners	Lessons from delivery feed origination and pricing	Ownership of residual risks



Photo: Dawn Waldman, U.S. Air Force, public domain, via Wikimedia Commons.

How to choose your two

Take the time-back case from your biggest pain point, and the new-offer case your board would value most. Run both through the five questions on page 10 before anyone talks about tools.

The three worked workflows that follow show what that looks like for a route decision, a procurement gate and a slipped connection date.



PART 3 | IN PRACTICE

Three commercial workflows, worked through

Each example follows the same eight steps, from the commercial pressure to the output the next project reuses. Run your own workflow through them.

1 Commercial pressure	why now	5 Agent groundwork	bounded work
2 Decision	the commitment	6 Human authority	who decides
3 Evidence	what it rests on	7 Control checks	sources and audit
4 Current workflow	where it waits	8 Reusable output	what carries on

Photo: Dennis Schroeder, U.S. Department of Energy, public domain, via Wikimedia Commons, cropped.

07 WORKFLOW 1 OF 3 | ROUTE TO MARKET

COMPOSITE EXAMPLE, NOT A CLIENT. NO RESULTS ARE CLAIMED.

Choosing the route to market for a solar project

One sealed bid, two alternatives, and a board that needs a fallback. The work is assembling evidence everyone trusts.

COMMERCIAL PRESSURE Why it is urgent	In AR8, a project in Pots 1 to 4 gets one sealed bid: one strike price, one capacity and one set of target dates.[10] The alternatives, a corporate PPA or a merchant route, have to be priced on the same evidence before the bid window closes.
DECISION The commitment	Bid into AR8, sign a corporate PPA or hold a merchant route. If bidding: the walk-away price, the capacity and the delivery year. The board also needs a fallback route if the bid fails.
EVIDENCE What it rests on	Yield assessment; capex and supply quotes with their validity dates; connection date and Gate 2 position; consent status and conditions; PPA term sheets; the round's administrative strike prices and rules; the financial model version.
CURRENT WORKFLOW Where it waits	One analyst updates the model. PPA indications sit in email. The board paper is rebuilt the week before the deadline, and nobody can say which supply quote the price assumed.
AGENT GROUNDWORK Bounded work	• Build an evidence register: source, date and owner for each input. • Normalise the PPA term sheets into one comparison. • Run the scenario set the team defines; the agent does not choose the scenarios. • Check the bid against the allocation framework rules; draft board paper sections with each figure linked to its source.
HUMAN AUTHORITY Who decides	The commercial director sets the scenarios and the walk-away price. The finance director signs off the model version. The board approves the route, the bid and the fallback.
CONTROL CHECKS Sources and audit	An assumptions register with owners and expiry dates. The model version is locked at board. A named reviewer signs the compliance checklist. Every board figure traces to a source. Price is visible only to named people.
REUSABLE OUTPUT What carries on	**A route decision record:** options considered, evidence and its dates, the anchor route and the fallback, the rationale, and what would change the decision. It feeds the next round, the PPA negotiation and the lender pack.

Source on this page. 10 DESNZ, AR8 Contract Allocation Framework, Rules 13.1 and 13.3, 2026.

07 WORKFLOW 2 OF 3 | PROCUREMENT GATE

COMPOSITE EXAMPLE, NOT A CLIENT. NO RESULTS ARE CLAIMED.

Taking an EPC package through its award gate

Most of the time is lost between the gates, waiting for the last answer. The work is making the comparison, the model and the contract agree.

COMMERCIAL PRESSURE Why it is urgent	Offers arrive in different formats. Prices and lead times can move between offer and award. The financial model and the contract drafts have to agree before investment committee, and the programme has to meet the connection date.
DECISION The commitment	Select a preferred bidder for the EPC or main supply package and enter exclusivity, on terms the model, the contract and the lenders can all accept.
EVIDENCE What it rests on	Supplier returns and price schedules; exclusions and qualifications; warranties and performance guarantees; programme against the connection date; clarification answers; the lenders' technical adviser requirements; model inputs.
CURRENT WORKFLOW Where it waits	An analyst rebuilds a comparison spreadsheet by hand. Clarifications run through email with no owner or due date. The model is updated after the recommendation, not before. The gate waits for the last answer.
AGENT GROUNDWORK Bounded work	• Normalise the returns into a structured template, like for like. • List exclusions and gaps, each with its document and page. • Keep the clarification log current, with an owner and due date for every question. • Cross-check commercial terms against the contract draft and the model inputs; draft the gate paper.
HUMAN AUTHORITY Who decides	The procurement lead challenges the comparison. The commercial director recommends the preferred bidder. Investment committee approves exclusivity. Risk allocation and the negotiation stay with people.
CONTROL CHECKS Sources and audit	Every comparison line cites the supplier document and page. Exceptions escalate to the procurement lead. Conflicts between model, contract and comparison are flagged before the gate. Supplier pricing is visible only to the tender team.
REUSABLE OUTPUT What carries on	**A gate record:** the comparison, the clarifications and the reasons for the choice. Also a supplier return template for the next tender, and the evidence section of the lender pack.

07 WORKFLOW 3 OF 3 | GRID CONNECTION DATE SLIP

COMPOSITE EXAMPLE, NOT A CLIENT. NO RESULTS ARE CLAIMED.

A connection slips two years. Does the project still work?

Every date-bound commitment on the project now has to be checked against the new date. The board needs five answers, fast and traceable.

COMMERCIAL PRESSURE
Why it is urgent

The network operator moves the connection date back two years. Land, consent, equipment and revenue commitments were all planned around the old date, and some notice periods may already be running.

DECISION
The commitment

Accept the new date and re-plan, seek an earlier or alternative connection, restructure the project, or stop spending.

EVIDENCE
Five questions

- **Land option:** does the option or lease run past the new date, and on what extension terms?
- **Consent validity:** does the consent expire, or must works start, before the new date?
- **Equipment commitments:** which reservations, deposits and delivery slots are tied to the old date?
- **Revenue agreement:** do the PPA or CfD milestones, target dates and long-stop dates still hold?
- **Returns timing:** how do returns, financing and the development budget move with two more years?

CURRENT WORKFLOW
Where it waits

Each question goes to a different team or adviser. Dates are pulled from contracts by hand. Nobody holds one list of date-bound obligations, and the board paper is out of date when it arrives.

AGENT GROUNDWORK
Bounded work

- Extract every date, notice period and condition from the land, consent, supply and revenue documents, with clause and page.
- Build one date map against the new connection date; flag conflicts and notice deadlines.
- Re-run the model cases the finance lead sets; draft the options paper.

HUMAN AUTHORITY
Who decides

The development director owns the response. Legal counsel confirms contract readings. The finance lead signs off the model. The board chooses the option. Conversations with landowners, suppliers and offtakers stay with people.

CONTROL CHECKS
Sources and audit

Every extracted date cites document, clause and page. Uncertain readings go to legal review. The offer letter version is recorded. Each notice deadline has a named owner. Changes and approvals are logged.

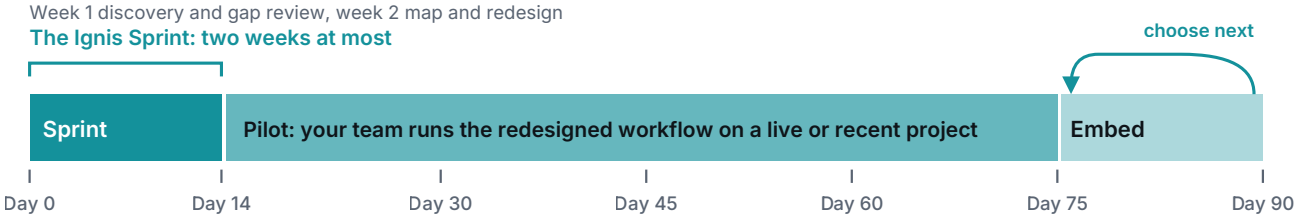
REUSABLE OUTPUT
What carries on

A live date-dependency register for the project, which the next offer, consent variation or refinancing starts from; and a slip playbook the next project can reuse.

08 WHERE TO START

Start with your biggest pain points

So what: find your two or three biggest pain points and their causes. Redesign the process before automating anything. That first step is quick.



WEEK 1

Discovery and gap review

A leadership conversation on goals, the self-check for each stage, and the two or three biggest pain points with their root causes.

You get: where value leaks, and where agents would and would not help.

WEEK 2

Map and redesign

Map the chosen workflow on one project's documents. Question, remove, simplify; structure the data; decide what people keep, what agents carry and where the gates sit.

You get: the redesigned process and a pilot plan.

TO ABOUT DAY 75

Pilot

Your team runs the redesigned workflow on a live or recent project. We help build the agents with your IT team and partners. Your team makes every decision.

You get: a lessons log and what to change.

DAYS 76 TO 90

Embed and choose next

Ownership, documentation and training. Lessons go into the context layer. Pick the next workflow or the first new-offer test.

You get: a 12-month plan along the ladder.

HOW IGNIS WORKS WITH YOU

Advisory led and hands-on. Ignis leads the diagnosis, process redesign, data requirements, governance, use-case selection, evaluation and adoption. Yorik finds the use cases, sets the strategy and content, and helps build the agents with your IT team and partners.

Where deeper platform engineering is needed, we work with appropriate technical specialists. You own and run the system.

Guardrails

- You own and run the system.
- Your data stays yours, in your environment.
- Your people make every decision.
- Platform-agnostic: the process comes before the platform.

Talk it through with Yorik

One question you can answer in one reply: which piece of work does your team rebuild by hand most often today, the grid pack, the tender comparison or the lender log? Send it to **ignisleadership.com/contact** and we will come back with where agents would and would not help.

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Method and limits

Worked example (page 2). 60 MW × 8,760 hours × 11% capacity factor = 57,816 MWh a year at the AR7 solar price of £65.23/MWh.[6] Present value uses a 20-year annuity factor at 7% (10.594). The 11% capacity factor, the 7% discount rate and the one-month hold-up are Ignis assumptions, not sourced figures. The example ignores indexation, merchant tail and costs.

Fact, view and example. Numbered figures are facts from the sources above. The maturity ladder, the step-by-step path, the use-case table, the workflow format and the 90-day path are Ignis frameworks, free to use with your team; they are views, not data. All worked examples and workflows are composites, not clients, and claim no results.

What this guide does not cover. Model choice, detailed technical architecture and the price of tools.

Photographs

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